

From search strings to a finished PRISMA flow.

One workbook, ten connected sheets — every PRISMA 2020 number computes itself from your screening decisions. Starting takes less time than making coffee.

Microsoft Excel (recommended)

1. Unzip nothing — just double-click `Systematic-Review-Tracker.xlsx`.
2. If Excel shows a yellow "Protected View" bar, click **Enable Editing** (the file comes from a download, that's all).
3. Read the **Start Here** tab (60 seconds), then write your criteria into **Protocol** before you screen anything.

Google Sheets

1. Go to `sheets.google.com` and open a blank spreadsheet.
2. Menu **File** → **Import** → **Upload**, choose `Systematic-Review-Tracker.xlsx`.
3. Pick **"Replace spreadsheet"** and confirm. Formulas, dropdowns and colors survive the trip.
4. Rename the file (e.g. "My Systematic Review") — done.

LibreOffice & Apple Numbers

LibreOffice Calc opens the file out of the box. Apple Numbers works too — minor visual differences (colors, column widths) are possible. For the smoothest experience we recommend Excel or Google Sheets.

Three habits that make it work

- ① Fill the **Protocol** before you screen — decidable criteria screen fast.
- ② Never leave the **Type** column blank in Search Log (it drives the PRISMA counts).
- ③ Enter your duplicates removed once in **Dedup** — every downstream number updates.

Good to know

- **Dashboard** and **PRISMA Flow** compute themselves — never type there (both are protected against accidents; you can unprotect them anytime).
- Records from citation searching, websites or experts skip T/A screening — enter them directly in **Full-Text** with Arm = Other source.
- PRISMA 2020 is a reporting guideline: paste your computed numbers into the official flow diagram template from prisma-statement.org.
- The **AI Prompts** sheet: copy a prompt, fill the [brackets], paste into ChatGPT, Claude or any assistant. The decisions stay yours.
- Duplicate the file per review. Archive, don't delete — your screening log is your audit trail.
- **Questions or a broken formula?** Message us on Etsy or kontakt@arbeitstyp.de — we answer within 48 h.